Elissa Huang

PRODUCT DESIGNER · AI-POWERED EXPERIENCES & DESIGN TOOLS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A product designer who designs for **the moment an AI isn't sure**: confidence states in an ML pricing tool, **source-linked briefs** people can verify, and classification that hands hard calls to a person. Also builds the tools, from Figma plugins to **agent harnesses** to an app **published on the App Store and Google Play**, and designs complex marketplace experiences across **desktop web, mobile web, and native iOS and Android apps**, combining systems thinking, research, and hands-on design to establish reusable patterns and align product, engineering, and design partners.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **2×+ the attachment rate of a typical service:** led end-to-end design of trading-card grading in the purchase flow, aligning 11 teams; grading attachment later **tripled** in offer-based purchases.
- **Up to a week → ~10 min for localized mockups:** AI-built Figma plugins adopted by designers across six product teams.
- **AI tools with a harness built in:** a source-linked AI project assistant (**estimated ~90% less time** gathering context) and an accessibility audit grounded in the company standard (**estimated ~80% fewer escalations**).
- **Judging when AI fits, and when it doesn't:** tested my lesson-ordering algorithm against Claude and kept the algorithm; rejected an agent's database design that couldn't handle traditional and simplified Chinese.
- **Shipped AI-built products:** Backgammon Rounds on the App Store and Google Play, and a reading app where **my 5-year-old learned ~50 characters in a month**.

SKILLS

AI Experience Design: Designing for Model Uncertainty (Confidence States) · Human-in-the-Loop Workflows · Classification with Human Review · Human Verification & Source Attribution · User Feedback Loops for Model Improvement

AI Development & Tooling: Claude Code · Cursor · Claude Skills · Agent Harness Design · Agent Evaluation (Algorithm vs. LLM) · MCP Integrations · Custom GPTs & Knowledge Files · Figma Plugin Development · AI-Assisted Testing · Synthetic Personas

Design: Interaction Design · Systems Thinking · Experience Architecture · Reusable Design Patterns · Cross-Platform Product Design · Visual Design · Rapid Prototyping · Figma

Research & Collaboration: Usability Testing · Workshop Facilitation · Cross-Functional Alignment · Design Critique · Mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

eBay

October 2016 – Present

Staff Product Designer

AI TOOLS & DESIGN ENABLEMENT

- Designed and built an **AI project assistant** (case study): Claude skills connected through MCP to Slack, Zoom, Outlook, and Google Drive that generate **source-linked briefs** on a project's history, decisions, and dependencies,

with verification steps. In internal use across the core design team, with an **estimated ~90% less time** spent gathering context and summarizing decisions.

- Building **coded templates with Claude Code** for the high-volume purchase journey, from search results to order details, plus a **library of every service** for comparing content and visual variation. In my own use so far, a new service's first end-to-end designs go **from 1–2 days to ~5 min** (estimate); intended as a shared foundation for other teams' service features.
- Built an **AI design-skills toolkit for Claude Code and Cursor** (case study) covering accessibility audits, handoff checks, Figma critiques, and converting mockups into working UI. Built the **harness** that makes the output reliable: checks grounded in the company accessibility standard, spot-checked against manual reviews, with judgment calls returned to the designer as Figma comments. The accessibility audit catches issues before engineering handoff, including gaps such as screen-reader order that often went unreviewed, and is **estimated to cut accessibility-team escalations by about 80%**.
- Shared the toolkit with all eBay design teams, where **a few teams adopted it**.
- Built **research-grounded synthetic personas** from user research pulled in through MCP to check early feature concepts and raise questions for further research; the personas split between collectors wanting social connection and those wanting only to transact.
- Built **Figma plugins** with AI-assisted development: Mock Translate cut localized mockups **from up to a week to ~10 min**, and an amount calculator fills in prices and totals across designs; **adopted by designers across six product teams**.

FRAMEWORKS & SYSTEMS

- Co-developing a **cross-category trust framework**, defining shared principles, signal categories, and visual treatment for trust signals. Building a **classification assistant as a custom GPT**, with stress-tested category definitions written into knowledge files, that checks a program's eligibility, places it in an existing category where possible, and judges whether a new category is justified, **referring unclear cases to the human committee**; requesters who disagree can also go to the committee.
- Developed a **cross-category pattern for adding services to multi-item carts**, aligning six product and functional areas, and documented existing service presentation patterns in a **shared reference used by teams across product categories**.
- **Audited seven pricing experiences** across the company and found they used four different sales-matching methods and four different headline prices. Ran a workshop that surfaced the problem and led to a **community of practice with agreed ownership (RASCI)**; product later **aligned on one pricing data source**. Wrote shared guidance for price charts, covering tooltips, axis labels, data frequency, and full numbers that work across languages.
- Developed a **multi-tier service pattern** for services offered in several configurations, setting **cross-platform design direction** for how buyers see a service's options.

PRODUCT DELIVERY

- Led **end-to-end design of an integrated trading-card grading service**, connecting buyer and seller experiences across enrollment, checkout, tracking, and buyer disputes, and **aligning 11 teams** on one experience. The service **launched with 2×+ the attachment rate of a typical service**, and its extensible enrollment structure accommodated additional service options.
- Integrated **paid grading into offer-based purchases** that bypass standard checkout, **tripling grading attachment** after launch.
- Established the **cross-platform foundation for a machine-learning collectible pricing tool**, designing around two non-generative models (card identification and sales matching) that aren't always right, as one component shared

by scanning, the item page, and collections. Chose with data science to lead with the **median of recent sales** to limit outliers, helped shape **confidence-based match states**, and designed a **price-accuracy feedback prompt** whose ratings go to data science for review. In a survey of the wider product (about **90% satisfaction**), users named price insights among the features they use most.

- Led **buyer-side design for authentication and managed shipping**, aligning legal, shipping, and business partners on service requirements; secured agreement on a design that simplifies service communication across buyer and seller touchpoints.
- Identified a broader opportunity for a **collectible buyback concept** beyond its original use, developing exploratory designs for listing creation and other marketplace touchpoints. The expanded concept was approved as a **standalone initiative, now available to selected sellers**.

AI-BUILT PRODUCTS

- **Chinese reading app for kids** (case study): designing and building a Flutter app that turns any book into lessons, for kids who speak Chinese but can't yet read it. **My 5-year-old learned ~50 characters in a month** from the first book and now reads almost all of it alone; my 3-year-old moves through lessons without help.
  - **Lesson builder:** OCR extracts a book's text, and an ordering algorithm sets the teaching order. I built a **comparison tool for ordering settings**, tested the algorithm **against Claude**, found the quality about the same, and kept the algorithm. Parents can then edit the lesson.
  - **Data model:** rejected the agent's proposal of one table for traditional and simplified characters, because the mapping isn't one-to-one and pronunciation differs by region; chose one dictionary per script, keyed by pronunciation, with a linking table.
  - **Child-facing design:** pictures over words, oversized touch targets, karaoke-style highlighting for reading order, no penalty for mistakes, and rewards that drove **38 short sessions in one sitting**.
  - **AI-built assets:** designed the character with ChatGPT and set up a tool where an agent turns a static image into animations in Rive; plus AI-assisted regression tests.
- **Backgammon Rounds**: designed and built a mobile game with Claude Code and Cursor in Flutter, with rules and a three-level computer opponent written from scratch; **published on the App Store and Google Play**.

TALKS, WORKSHOPS & COMMUNITY

- Ran **AI workflow workshops and demos attended by 50+ people** at eBay, on AI workflows and the design-skills toolkit.
- **Mentored junior designers, led design critiques, and ran working sessions** with product and engineering partners.
- Facilitated a **pricing workshop across teams** that led to a community of practice with agreed ownership.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Yahoo

April 2014 – October 2016

Sr. Interaction Designer

Designed interfaces and interaction flows for internal advertising publishing tools, simplifying complex publishing workflows.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science · Simon Fraser University